

HUMILITY

1. Passage anchor

> “However, what made her stand out was the combination of knowledge, judgement, and **humility**.”

Passage meaning

humility = the quality of not considering yourself more important, talented, or deserving than other people, even when you have genuine ability or success

謙遜；謙虛；不自大的態度

Here, Ms. Lau is extremely knowledgeable and intelligent, but she does not show off or behave arrogantly.

That connection becomes explicit immediately afterwards:

> “She was sharp without being arrogant...”

Practice

1. Her intelligence was matched by genuine **humility**.

她除了聰明，也有真正的**謙遜**。

2. Despite her achievements, she always spoke with **humility**.

儘管成就很高，她說話時始終保持**謙虛**。

Core meaning of HUMILITY

2. humility — modest view of your own importance

= the quality of being modest and not believing that you are more important or superior to others

謙遜；謙虛

Examples

1. Great leaders often combine confidence with **humility**.

優秀的領導者往往兼具自信與**謙遜**。

2. She accepted the award with **humility**.

她以**謙遜的態度**接受了這個獎項。

This is the central and overwhelmingly dominant modern meaning.

Realistic awareness of limitations

3. humility — recognition of what you do not know or cannot do

= willingness to recognize your limitations, mistakes, or incomplete knowledge

****謙遜；承認自身局限的態度****

This is closely related to the core meaning, but very important in academic and intellectual contexts.

Examples

1. Good researchers need the ****humility**** to admit when the evidence is incomplete.

好的研究人員需要有****謙遜態度****，承認證據並不完整。

2. It takes ****humility**** to say, "I was wrong."

願意說「我錯了」需要****謙遜****。

4. intellectual humility

= willingness to recognize that your beliefs, knowledge, or reasoning may be incomplete or mistaken

****智識謙遜；知識上的謙遜****

Examples

1. ****Intellectual humility**** allows people to reconsider their assumptions.

****智識謙遜****讓人願意重新檢視自己的假設。

2. A good scientist needs both confidence and ****intellectual humility****.

好的科學家既需要自信，也需要****知識上的謙遜****。

Very relevant to the passage's theme of genuine intelligence.

Modest behavior despite achievement

5. humility — modest behavior or manner

= a modest way of behaving, especially despite success, status, knowledge, or talent

****謙和；謙遜態度****

Examples

1. She handled her success with remarkable ****humility****.

她以令人佩服的****謙遜態度****面對自己的成功。

2. His ****humility**** made him easy to work with.

他的****謙和****讓人很容易和他合作。

This is not a separate dictionary sense so much as a high-value realization of the central meaning.

Willingness to learn from others

6. humility — openness to correction and learning

= willingness to listen, receive feedback, and learn from other people instead of assuming you already know everything

****虛心；願意受教****

Examples

1. She had the ****humility to learn from younger colleagues****.

她有****虛心向年輕同事學習的態度****。

2. Improvement requires enough ****humility to accept feedback****.

進步需要有足夠的****謙虛態度去接受回饋****。

A useful contextual extension of the core concept.

Religious / moral use

7. humility — moral or spiritual virtue

= absence of excessive pride, especially regarded as a moral or religious virtue

****謙卑；謙遜****

Examples

1. The tradition emphasizes ****humility**** and service to others.

這個傳統強調****謙卑****和服務他人。

2. **Humility** is regarded as an important virtue in many religious traditions.

在許多宗教傳統中，**謙卑**被視為重要美德。

Traditional Chinese **謙卑** is particularly natural in religious or moral contexts.

Humbling experience / reduced pride

8. learn humility

= become more modest, often after an experience that reveals your limitations

學會謙遜；變得謙虛

Examples

1. Failure taught him **humility**.

失敗讓他**學會了謙遜**。

2. The experience gave her a new sense of **humility**.

那段經歷讓她對自己的能力有了更**謙遜的認知**。

9. a lesson in humility

= experience that makes someone realize they are less powerful, capable, or knowledgeable than they thought

讓人學會謙遜的一課；挫挫銳氣的經歷

Examples

1. Losing the match was a **lesson in humility**.

輸掉比賽是一次**讓人學會謙遜的經歷**。

2. Starting a new job can sometimes be a **lesson in humility**.

開始一份新工作有時會成為一次**讓人認清自身不足的經歷**。

With humility

10. with humility

= in a modest, non-arrogant manner

謙遜地；以謙虛態度

Examples

1. She accepted the criticism ****with humility****.
她****謙虛地****接受了批評。
2. He spoke about his achievements ****with humility****.
他以****謙遜的態度****談自己的成就。

Have the humility to...

11. have the humility to do something

= be modest or self-aware enough to admit, accept, or do something
****有足夠的謙遜去.....；能虛心.....****

Examples

1. She had the ****humility to admit that she did not know the answer****.
她能****虛心承認自己不知道答案****。
2. Good leaders have the ****humility to ask for help****.
好的領導者有足夠的****謙遜去尋求幫助****。

Very high-value pattern.

Show / demonstrate humility

12. show humility

= behave in a way that demonstrates modesty and awareness of limitations
****表現出謙遜****

Examples

1. He ****showed humility**** after winning the award.
他得獎後仍然****表現得很謙遜****。
2. Admitting your mistake can ****show humility****.
承認錯誤可以****展現謙遜****。

Sense of humility

13. a sense of humility

= attitude of modesty arising from awareness of one's place, limitations, or dependence on others

****謙遜感；謙卑之心****

Examples

1. The experience gave him a greater ****sense of humility****.
那段經歷讓他更加****謙遜****。
2. Good education can encourage curiosity and a ****sense of humility****.
良好的教育可以培養好奇心與****謙遜之心****。

Related forms

14. humble — adjective

= not believing or behaving as if you are more important or superior to others

****謙虛的；謙遜的****

Examples

1. She is brilliant but very ****humble****.
她才華出眾，卻非常****謙虛****。
2. He remained ****humble**** despite his success.
儘管很成功，他仍保持****謙遜****。

This is the closest adjective family member.

Humble — low status / simple

15. humble — modest in status, size, or importance

= ordinary, simple, or not important in social status or scale

****普通的；不起眼的；簡樸的****

Examples

1. He came from **humble beginnings**.

他出身**平凡 / 寒微**。

2. The restaurant began as a **humble street stall**.

這家餐廳最初只是一個**不起眼的街邊攤**。

This is a genuinely distinct sense of **humble**.

16. humble beginnings

= modest or poor circumstances at the beginning of someone's life, career, or organization

寒微出身；平凡的起點

Examples

1. The company grew from **humble beginnings**.

公司從一個**不起眼的起點**逐漸發展起來。

2. Despite her **humble beginnings**, she became a respected scientist.

儘管**出身平凡**，她後來成為受人尊敬的科學家。

Humble — modest claim / self-description

17. my humble opinion

= conventional way of presenting an opinion modestly

愚見；依我淺見；我的小小看法

Examples

1. In my **humble opinion**, the second explanation is clearer.

依我淺見，第二種解釋比較清楚。

2. That is, in my **humble opinion**, the best option.

那個，**依我個人淺見**，是最好的選擇。

Sometimes sincere, sometimes humorous or ironic.

Verb: humble

18. humble someone

= make someone realize that they are not as powerful, skilled, or important as they thought

****使某人變得謙遜；使認清自身不足；挫其銳氣****

Examples

1. The defeat ****humbléd the team****.
那次失敗讓球隊****認清了自己的不足****。
2. The experience ****humbléd him****.
那段經歷讓他****變得謙遜****。

This is an important distinct verb sense.

19. be humbled

= feel modest, grateful, or less self-important because of an experience, honor, or realization

****深感謙卑；感到受寵若驚；變得謙遜****

Examples

1. I was ****humbléd by their kindness****.
他們的善意讓我****深感謙卑 / 受寵若驚****。
2. She said she was ****humbléd by the award****.
她說自己獲得這個獎感到****十分榮幸而謙卑****。

Important nuance: in public statements, ****humbléd**** often expresses gratitude and modesty rather than literal humiliation.

Humbling

20. humbling

= making you realize your limitations or making you feel modest

****令人謙卑的；讓人認清自身不足的****

Examples

1. It was a ****humbling experience****.
那是一段****讓人學會謙遜的經歷****。

2. Teaching beginners can be surprisingly **humbling**.

教導初學者有時會是相當**令人謙卑的經驗**。

Humbly

21. humbly

= in a modest or respectful manner

謙虛地；謙卑地

Examples

1. She **humbly accepted** the award.

她**謙遜地接受**了獎項。

2. I **humbly admit** that I was wrong.

我**謙虛地承認**自己錯了。

Can sound formal or rhetorical.

Humiliation is NOT the same family meaning

22. humility vs humiliation

These look similar but must be kept sharply separate.

humility

= voluntary or positive modesty

謙遜；謙虛

humiliation

= strong embarrassment, shame, or loss of dignity caused by being made to look foolish or inferior

羞辱；屈辱

Compare:

> She showed **humility**.

> 她展現了謙遜。

> She suffered public **humiliation**.

> 她受到公開羞辱。

Do not confuse them.

Key contrasts

23. humility vs modesty

****humility****

= deep recognition that you are not superior and may have limitations

****謙遜 ; 謙卑****

****modesty****

= not talking excessively about your abilities or achievements; can also refer to reserved behavior

****謙虛 ; 不自誇****

They overlap strongly.

Compare:

> Her ****humility**** made her willing to learn from others.

> 她的謙遜讓她願意向別人學習。

> Out of ****modesty****, she played down her achievement.

> 出於謙虛，她淡化了自己的成就。

24. humility vs humbleness

****humbleness****

= quality of being humble

****謙遜****

It is grammatical, but ****humility**** is usually the more natural and established noun in formal/standard usage.

25. humility vs low self-esteem

****humility****

= realistic, non-arrogant view of yourself

****謙遜****

****low self-esteem****

= low sense of personal worth or confidence

****低自尊；缺乏自我價值感****

A humble person can still be highly confident.

This is essential to the passage:

Ms. Lau has:

****confidence + humility****

not:

****lack of confidence + humility****

26. humility vs insecurity

****insecurity****

= uncertainty or lack of confidence about yourself

****不安全感；缺乏自信****

****humility****

= not placing yourself above others and recognizing limitations

They are not the same.

27. humility vs shyness

****shyness****

= social nervousness or hesitation

****害羞；羞怯****

****humility****

= modest self-assessment and non-arrogance

****謙遜****

Someone can be:

* humble but socially confident

* shy but arrogant

* both

* neither

28. humility vs submission

****submission****

= yielding to another person's authority or control

****服從；屈從****

****humility****

does not mean allowing others to dominate you.

A humble person can still:

* disagree,

* lead,

* speak confidently,

* defend a position.

29. humility vs arrogance

This is the passage's most important contrast.

****humility****

= recognizing your strengths without treating yourself as superior

****謙遜****

****arrogance****

= believing or behaving as though you are more important, capable, or deserving than others

****傲慢；自大****

Compare:

> She was brilliant but ****humble****.

> 她非常出色，卻很謙遜。

> He acted as though nobody could teach him anything; that came across as ****arrogant****.

> 他表現得像沒有人能教他任何東西，顯得很傲慢。

30. humility vs confidence

These are not opposites.

****confidence****

= belief in your abilities

****自信****

****humility****

= realistic awareness that you do not know everything and are not superior to others

****謙遜****

A healthy combination is:

> ****confidence without arrogance + humility without self-doubt****

This is essentially how Ms. Lau is portrayed in the passage.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****humility**** is:

****a modest, realistic view of your own importance and ability****

From this develop:

Social character

humility

→ ****不自大 ; 謙遜****

Intellectual attitude

intellectual humility

→ ****承認自己可能不知道或判斷錯****

Learning

humility to accept feedback

→ ****虛心受教****

Spiritual/moral

humility

→ ****謙卑****

Experience

lesson in humility

→ **讓人認清自身不足的一課**

The adjective/verb family then expands:

humble person

→ **謙虛的人**

humble beginnings

→ **寒微 / 平凡的起點**

humble someone

→ **讓某人認清自己的局限**

humbling experience

→ **讓人學會謙遜的經歷**

The passage uses the positive character-quality branch:

****Ms. Lau is highly capable but does not behave as though she is superior to others.****

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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humility — modest character	不認為自己比別人更重要、更優秀，並保持不自大的態度；謙遜 / 謙虛
humility — awareness of limitations	願意承認自己的知識、能力或判斷可能有限
intellectual humility	願意承認自己的信念、知識或推理可能不完整或有錯；智識謙遜
humility — openness to learning	願意聆聽、接受回饋並向別人學習的虛心態度
humility — moral/religious	作為道德或宗教美德的謙卑、不驕傲
learn humility	經歷事情後變得更謙遜、認清自己的局限
a lesson in humility	讓人認清自己並非無所不能的經歷；使人學會謙遜的一課
with humility	以謙遜、不自大的態度

**have the humility to...	足夠謙遜，願意承認、接受或做某事	
**show humility	透過言行表現出謙遜	
**a sense of humility	對自身位置和局限保持的謙遜心態	
**humble — modest person	不自大、不認為自己高人一等的；謙虛的	
**humble — low/simple status	地位、出身、規模等普通、不顯赫的；平凡的 / 寒微的	
**humble beginnings	一個人、公司等起初平凡、貧困或不起眼的背景	
**my humble opinion	以謙虛語氣提出自己的看法；愚見 / 依我淺見	
**humble someone	使某人認清自己的局限，不再過度自信或自大	
**be humbled	因榮譽、經歷或他人善意而感到謙卑、受寵若驚或更謙遜	
**humbling	使人認識自己的局限、變得謙遜的	
**humbly	以謙虛、謙卑或恭敬的方式	
**humility vs humiliation	humility = 謙遜；humiliation = 羞辱 / 屈辱，兩者不可混淆	

Passage recap

> “...the combination of knowledge, judgement, and ****humility****.”

Here:

****humility**** = ****the quality of being highly capable without becoming proud, self-important, or arrogant****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****謙遜****

* ****謙虛****

* ****謙和****

* in a more moral/spiritual context: ****謙卑****

Natural contextual translation:

****她最突出的地方，在於她把知識、判斷力和謙遜結合在一起。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****humility****

= ****a modest attitude in which someone recognizes their abilities without considering themselves superior to others****

****謙遜；謙虛；不自大的態度****

The passage immediately reinforces this meaning:

> “She was sharp without being arrogant...”

So the key contrast is:

****brilliant + confident + humble****

not:

****brilliant + arrogant****

And importantly:

****humility ≠ low confidence****

A person can know they are capable while still remaining open, respectful, and willing to learn from others.